SENIOR CITIZEN SAVINGS SCHEME (SCSS) - SECURED RETIREMENT INCOME

SUPPLEMENTARY REFERENCE - Compiled from Official Government Portals (November 2026)

Department of Economic Affairs, Ministry of Finance, Government of India | Level: Central | Category: Senior Citizens & Retirement Savings

Official Portal: https://www.indiapost.gov.in and https://rbi.org.in

1. Overview & Scheme Highlights

Senior Citizen Savings Scheme (SCSS) is a premier government-guaranteed small savings scheme designed to provide senior citizens with a steady and secure quarterly retirement income with highest sovereign safety and attractive interest rates.

2. Financial Terms & Interest Payments

- Current Interest Rate: 8.2% per annum paid quarterly on 1st working day of April, July, October, and January.
- Minimum Deposit: Rs 1,000.
- Maximum Deposit Limit: Rs 30,00,000 (enhanced from Rs 15 Lakh in Budget 2023).
- Tenure: 5 years (can be extended in blocks of 3 years indefinitely upon application).
- Tax Deductions: Investment qualifies for tax deduction under Section 80C up to Rs 1.5 Lakh per financial year; interest is taxable as per income slab with TDS applicable above Rs 50,000.

3. Eligibility Criteria

- Indian citizens aged 60 years or above.
- Retired civilian employees aged 55 to 60 years who have retired on superannuation or VRS, provided account is opened within 1 month of receipt of retirement benefits.
- Retired Defence personnel aged 50 years and above (subject to conditions).
- Exclusions: Non-Resident Indians (NRIs) and Persons of Indian Origin (PIO) / Hindu Undivided Families (HUF) are NOT eligible to invest in SCSS.

4. Required Documents Checklist

1. Aadhaar Card (mandatory identification and address proof).
2. PAN Card (mandatory for deposits above Rs 50,000).
3. Age Proof (Voter ID, Passport, Birth Certificate, School Leaving Certificate).
4. Superannuation / Retirement Benefit Certificate (for retired individuals aged 55-60).
5. Two passport-size color photographs.
6. Cheque / DD for deposit amount.

5. Step-by-Step Account Opening Steps

Step 1: Visit any Post Office offering savings bank facilities or authorized branches of Public and Private Commercial Banks.
Step 2: Fill Form-A (SCSS Account Opening Form) and select quarterly interest credit mode into savings bank account.
Step 3: Attach KYC documents, retirement proof (if under 60), and nominee details.
Step 4: Deposit funds via cheque/DD (cash permitted only up to Rs 1 Lakh).
Step 5: Bank/Post Office issues SCSS Passbook containing deposit certificate and quarterly interest schedule.